

Liberality

Pleasing to God.

2 Corinthians 9:7 Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver.

Hebrews 13:16 But to do good and to Communicate forget not: for with such sacrifices God is well pleased.

God never forgets.

Hebrews 6:10 For God is not unrighteous to forget your work and labour of love, which ye have shewed toward his name, in that ye have ministered to the Saints, and do minister.

Christ set an example of.

2 Corinthians 8:9 For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

Characteristic of Saints.

Psalms 112:9 He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; his righteousness endureth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.

Isaiah 32:8 But the liberal deviseth liberal things; and by liberal things shall he stand. Unprofitable, without love.

1 Corinthians 13:3 And though I Bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and though I give my body to be burned, and have not Charity, it profiteth me nothing.

SHOULD BE EXERCISED

In the service of God.

Exodus 35:21-29 And they came, every one whose heart stirred him up, and every one whom his spirit made willing, and they brought the LORDS' offering to the work of The Tabernacle of the Congregation, and for all his service, and for the holy garments. 22 And they came, both men and women, as many as were willing hearted, and brought bracelets, and earrings, and rings, and tablets, all jewels of gold: and every man that offered offered an offering of gold unto the LORD. 23 And every man, with whom was found blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine linen, and goats' hair, and red skins of rams, and badgers' skins, brought them. 24 Every one that did offer an offering of silver and brass brought the LORDS' offering: and every man, with whom was found shittim wood for any work of the service, brought it. ...

Toward Saints.

Romans 12:13 Distributing to the necessity of Saints; given to hospitality.

Galatians 6:10 As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of Faith.

Toward servants.

Deuteronomy 15:12-14 And if thy brother, an Hebrew man, or an Hebrew woman, be sold unto thee, and serve thee six years; then in the seventh year thou shalt let him go free from thee. 13 And when thou sendest him out free from thee, thou shalt not let him go away empty: 14 Thou shalt furnish him liberally out of thy flock, and out of thy floor, and out of thy winepress: of that wherewith the LORD thy God hath blessed thee thou shalt give unto him.

Toward the poor.

Deuteronomy 15:11 For the poor shall never cease out of the land: therefore I command thee, saying, Thou shalt open thine hand wide unto thy brother, to thy poor, and to thy needy, in thy land.

Isaiah 58:7 Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him; and that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh?

Toward strangers.

Leviticus 25:35 And if thy brother be waxen poor, and fallen in decay with thee; then thou shalt relieve him: yea, though he be a stranger, or a sojourner; that he may live with thee.

Toward enemies.

Proverbs 25:21 If thine enemy be hungry, give him bread to eat; and if he be thirsty, give him water to drink:

Toward all men.

Galatians 6:10 As we have therefore opportunity, let us do good unto all men, especially unto them who are of the household of Faith.

In leading to those in want.

Matthew 5:42 Give to him that asketh thee, and from him that would borrow of thee turn not thou away.

In giving Alms.

Luke 12:33 Sell that ye have, and give Alms; provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure in the heavens that faileth not, where no Thief approacheth, neither moth corrupteth.

In relieving the destitute.

Isaiah 58:7 Is it not to deal thy bread to the hungry, and that thou bring the poor that are cast out to thy house? when thou seest the naked, that thou cover him; and that thou hide not thyself from thine own flesh?

In forwarding missions.

Philippians 4:14-16 Notwithstanding ye have well done, that ye did Communicate with my Affliction. 15 Now ye Philippians know also, that in the beginning of the Gospel, when I departed from Macedonia, no Church communicated with me as concerning giving and receiving, but ye only. 16 For even in Thessalonica ye sent once and again unto my necessity.

In rendering personal services.

Philippians 2:30 Because for the work of Christ he was nigh unto Death, not regarding his life, to supply your lack of service toward me.

Without ostentation.

Matthew 6:1-3 Take heed that ye do not your Alms before men, to be seen of them: otherwise ye have no reward of your Father which is in heaven. 2 Therefore when thou doest thine Alms, do not sound a trumpet before thee, as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may have glory of men. Verily I say unto you, They have their reward. 3 But when thou doest Alms, let not thy left hand know what thy right hand doeth:

With simplicity.

Romans 12:8 Or he that exhorteth, on exhortation: he that giveth, let him do it with simplicity; he that ruleth, with diligence; he that sheweth mercy, with cheerfulness.

According to Ability.

Deuteronomy 16:10 And thou shalt keep the feast of weeks unto the LORD thy God with a tribute of a freewill offering of thine hand, which thou shalt give unto the LORD thy God, according as the LORD thy God hath blessed thee:

Deuteronomy 16:17 Every man shall give as he is able, according to the blessing of the LORD thy God which he hath given thee.

1 Corinthians 16:2 Upon the First Day of the week let every one of you lay by him in store, as God hath prospered him, that there be no gatherings when I come.

Willingly.

Exodus 25:2 Speak unto the children of Israel, that they bring me an offering: of every man that giveth it willingly with his heart ye shall take my offering.

2 Corinthians 8:12 For if there be first a willing mind, it is accepted according to that a man hath, and not according to that he hath not.

Abundantly.

2 Corinthians 8:7 Therefore, as ye abound in every thing, in Faith, and utterance, and knowledge, and in all diligence, and in your love to us, see that ye abound in this grace also.

2 Corinthians 9:11-13 Being enriched in every thing to all bountifulness, which causeth through us thanksgiving to God. 12 For the administration of this service not only supplieth the want of the Saints, but is abundant also by many thanksgivings unto God; 13 Whiles by the experiment of this ministration they glorify God for your professed subjection unto the Gospel of Christ, and for your liberal distribution unto them, and

unto all men;

Exercise of, provokes others to.

2 Corinthians 9:2 For I know the forwardness of your mind, for which I boast of you to them of Macedonia, that Achaia was ready a year ago; and your zeal hath provoked very many.

Labor to be enabled to exercise.

Acts 20:35 I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.

Ephesians 4:28 Let him that stole steal no more: but rather let him labour, working with his hands the thing which is good, that he may have to give to him that needeth.

WANT OF,

Brings many a curse.

Proverbs 28:27 He that giveth unto the poor shall not lack: but he that hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.

A proof of not loving God.

1 John 3:17 But whoso hath this world's good, and seeth his brother have need, and shutteth up his Bowels of compassion from him, how dwelleth the love of God in him?

A proof of not having Faith.

James 2:14-16 What doth it profit, my Brethren, though a man say he hath Faith, and have not works? can Faith save him? 15 If a brother or sister be naked, and destitute of daily food, 16 And one of you say unto them, Depart in peace, be ye warmed and filled; notwithstanding ye give them not those things which are needful to the body; what doth it profit?

Blessings connected with.

Psalms 41:1 Blessed is he that considereth the poor: the LORD will deliver him in time of trouble.

Proverbs 22:9 He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; for he giveth of his bread to the poor.

Acts 20:35 I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive.

Promises to.

Psalms 112:9 He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; his righteousness endureth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.

Proverbs 11:25 The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself.

Proverbs 28:27 He that giveth unto the poor shall not lack: but he that hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.

Ecclesiastes 11:1-2 Cast thy bread upon the waters: for thou shalt find it after many days. 2 Give a portion to seven, and also to eight; for thou knowest not what evil shall be upon the earth.

Exhortations to.

Luke 3:11 He answereth and saith unto them, He that hath two Coats, let him impart to him that hath none; and he that hath meat, let him do likewise.

Luke 11:41 But rather give Alms of such things as ye have; and, behold, all things are clean unto you.

Acts 20:35 I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to

give than to receive.

1 Corinthians 16:1 Now concerning the collection for the Saints, as I have given order to the Churches of Galatia, even so do ye.

1 Timothy 6:17-18 Charge them that are rich in this world, that they be not highminded, nor trust in uncertain riches, but in the living God, who giveth us richly all things to enjoy; 18 That they do good, that they be rich in good works, ready to distribute, willing to Communicate;

Exemplified.

Princes of Israel,

Numbers 7:2 That the Princes of Israel, heads of the house of their Fathers, who were the Princes of the tribes, and were over them that were numbered, offered:

Boaz,

Ruth 2:16 And let fall also some of the handfuls of purpose for her, and leave them, that she may glean them, and rebuke her not.

David,

2 Samuel 9:7 And David said unto him, Fear not: for I will surely shew thee kindness for Jonathan thy Father's sake, and will restore thee all the land of Saul thy Father; and thou shalt eat bread at my table continually.

2 Samuel 9:10 Thou therefore, and thy sons, and thy servants, shall till the land for him, and thou shalt bring in the fruits, that thy master's son may have food to eat: but Mephibosheth thy master's son shall eat bread alway at my table. Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.

Barzillai, ect.

2 Samuel 17:28 Brought beds, and basons, and earthen vessels, and wheat, and barley, and flour, and parched Corn, and beans, and lentiles, and parched pulse, Araunah,

2 Samuel 24:22 And Araunah said unto David, Let my lord the king take and offer up what seemeth good unto him: behold, here be oxen for burnt sacrifice, and threshing instruments and other instruments of the oxen for wood.

Shunammite,

2 Kings 4:8 And it fell on a day, that Elisha passed to Shunem, where was a great woman; and she constrained him to eat bread. And so it was, that as oft as he passed by, he turned in thither to eat bread.

2 Kings 4:10 Let us make a little chamber, I pray thee, on the wall; and let us set for him there a bed, and a table, and a stool, and a candlestick: and it shall be, when he cometh to us, that he shall turn in thither.

Judah,

2 Chronicles 24:10-11 And all the Princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest, until they had made an end. 11 Now it came to pass, that at what time the chest was brought unto the king's office by the hand of the Levites, and when they saw that there was much money, the king's scribe and the High Priest's officer came and emptied the chest, and took it, and carried it to his place again. Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in Abundance.

Nehemiah,

Nehemiah 7:70 And some of the chief of the Fathers gave unto the work. The Tirshatha gave to the treasure a thousand drams of gold, fifty basons, five hundred and thirty priests' garments.

Jews,

Nehemiah 7:71-72 And some of the chief of the Fathers gave to the treasure of the

work twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand and two hundred pound of silver. 72 And that which the rest of the people gave was twenty thousand drams of gold, and two thousand pound of silver, and threescore and seven priests' garments.

Job,

Job 29:15-16 I was eyes to the blind, and feet was I to the lame. 16 I was a Father to the poor: and the cause which I knew not I searched out.

Nebuzaradan,

Jeremiah 40:4-5 And now, behold, I loose thee this day from the chains which were upon thine hand. If it seem good unto thee to come with me into Babylon, come; and I will look well unto thee: but if it seem ill unto thee to come with me into Babylon, forbear: behold, all the land is before thee: whither it seemeth good and Convenient for thee to go, thither go. 5 Now while he was not yet gone back, he said, Go back also to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan, whom the king of Babylon hath made governor over the cities of Judah, and dwell with him among the people: or go wheresoever it seemeth Convenient unto thee to go. So the captain of the guard gave him victuals and a reward, and let him go.

Joanna, ect.

Luke 8:3 And Joanna the wife of Chuza Herod's steward, and Susanna, and many others, which ministered unto him of their substance.

Zaccheus,

Luke 19:8 And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord; Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold.

Primitive Christians,

Acts 2:45 And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.

Barnabas,

Acts 4:36-37 And Joses, who by the Apostles was surnamed Barnabas, (which is, being interpreted, The son of consolation,) a Levite, and of the country of Cyprus, 37 Having land, sold it, and brought the money, and laid it at the Apostles' feet.

Dorcas,

Acts 9:36 Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named Tabitha, which by interpretation is called Dorcas: this woman was full of good works and almsdeeds which she did.

Cornelius,

Acts 16:2 Which was well reported of by the Brethren that were at Lystra and Iconium.

Church of Antioch,

Acts 11:29-30 Then the disciples, every man according to his Ability, determined to send relief unto the Brethren which dwelt in Judaea: 30 Which also they did, and sent it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

Lydia,

Acts 16:15 And when she was baptized, and her household, she Besought us, saying, If ye have judged me to be Faithful to the Lord, come into my house, and abide there. And she constrained us.

Paul,

Acts 20:34 Yea, ye yourselves know, that these hands have ministered unto my necessities, and to them that were with me.

Stephanas, ect.

1 Corinthians 16:17 I am glad of the coming of Stephanas and Fortunatus and

Achaicus: for that which was lacking on your part they have supplied.

Extraordinary Exemplified.

Israelites,

Exodus 36:5 And they spake unto Moses, saying, The people bring much more than enough for the service of the work, which the LORD commanded to make.

Poor widow,

Mark 12:42-44 And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites, which make a farthing. 43 And he called unto him his disciples, and saith unto them, Verily I say unto you, That this poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury: 44 For all they did cast in of their Abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.

Churches of Macedonia,

2 Corinthians 8:1-5 Moreover, Brethren, we do you to wit of the grace of God bestowed on the Churches of Macedonia; 2 How that in a great trial of Affliction the Abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their liberality. 3 For to their power, I bear record, yea, and beyond their power they were willing of themselves; 4 Praying us with much intreaty that we would receive the gift, and take upon us the Fellowship of the ministering to the Saints. ...